

REPORT ON PROGRAMS ATTENDED ON SATUDAY THE 27TH OF NOVEMBER 2021

First program attended: official launching of the MTN mobile merchant account of the shia community of Ghana.

Theme: towards economic self sufficiency

Venue: office of the shia national chief imam, Accra newtown

Time: 2:00pm to 3:30pm

Attendance: the Shia Imam, the Iranian Ambassador, the Iranian cultural counselor and many more

Outline of program

This event was organized by the leadership of the shia muslim community of Ghana to launch a mobile banking platform that would serve as a business oriented wing for the financing of the community's need. And the event unfolded as follows:

1. Introduction by the Shia national chief imam. The imam in his opening remarks made the following statements:
 - Firstly, he outlined how the Shia Muslim community began in Ghana. He mentioned that it began with only two people (the late imam and himself) which later increased to three and then continued to grow towards the current population of several thousands.
 - He furthered that, throughout their journey, Iran has always been a willing and constant supporter of their works to this day, which include: education, missionary works and humanitarian ventures.
 - He then highlighted that, Iran itself has been hit with sanctions and hence, their ability to support communities abroad has been weakened, which calls for all depended communities to find ways of financing their own affairs.
 - The imam then mentioned that, the Shia community is not as well organized as the Ahmadi Muslim community is in terms of resource mobilization and growth. Therefore, the need for such is needed within the Shia community.
 - He concluded by highlighting the need for self-identification within the Shia community as well as the need to develop a culture of giving within the community as opposed to taking from others.

The setting up of this mobile banking platform, he said; is a step towards realizing the above mentioned goals.

2. The Iranian ambassador to Ghana was the next to speak and he made the following statements after giving thanks for the opportunity afforded him:
 - He showed appreciation for the efforts made by the Shia community of Ghana to attain financial self reliance.
 - He then highlighted certain factors that helped sustain the Shia community of Ghana thus far, which include: peaceful coexistence with other religious bodies in Ghana as well as the political structure.
 - He then mentioned that, despite the sanctions, Iran is still supporting needy communities abroad including Lebanon, Yemen, Palestine and elsewhere. Therefore, Iran shall continue to support the Shia community of Ghana regardless.
 - He then mentioned 'Iran clinic' as been another form of help that Iran offers to Ghana and to the Shia community.
3. Then, the national treasurer of the Shia community spoke next, and he said the following:
 - ✓ That, this mobile banking platform is a stepping stone towards greater heights

- ✓ That the community has a bank account which has three signatories. Namely: the treasurer, imam and the head of the lower assembly; thereby making the account very secure and firm
- ✓ That the activities of the mobile banking platform shall be shared in a whatsapp group that shall have all interested members of the community in it in order to foster transparency and accountability.

4. Mr yusuf (an assistant at the foreign ministry of Ghana) spoke last:
- o This platform offers the easiest way to contribute to the Shia community
 - o He hopes contributions would be forthcoming
 - o He thanked Iran for its support
 - o He then called upon the Shia youth to be a part of this initiative.

The program concluded at 3:04pm with prayers.